

Specifications

for the Organization of an International FCI Article Search (FCI-StöPr) Competition

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1. Application and Awarding

The “International FCI Article Search (FCI-StöPr) Competition” shall be held annually. The exact date shall be determined by the organizer. Depending on the number of participants, the number of event days shall be fixed accordingly. National Canine Organizations of the FCI (FCI-NCOs) wishing to organize this competition must submit a written application to the President of the FCI Utility Dogs Commission at least two years prior to the intended date.

The application must include:

- Name of the FCI National Canine Organization (FCI-NCO)
- Date of the International FCI Article Search Competition
- Venue of the competition
- Name and address of the responsible Head of Organization

The FCI Utility Dogs Commission shall appoint an FCI full member NCO to organize and conduct the competition. The appointment shall be made by majority vote. In the event of a tie, the President of the FCI Utility Dogs Commission shall cast the deciding vote.

The appointed FCI-NCO bears full responsibility for the smooth execution of the event.

All National Canine Organizations must be invited no later than one year prior to the intended date.

The entry fee shall be determined by the FCI Utility Dogs Commission (€ 60,-).

2. Organization

A catalogue must be available listing all participants and the approximate timetable. Participants shall receive catalogue numbers, which must also be worn as starting numbers. The complete text of Section 8 “RANKING AND TITLES” must be printed in the catalogue. The essential parts of the catalogue must be published in at least two FCI languages, one of which must be English.

Participating NCOs must bring their national flags. These shall be displayed together with the FCI flag in a suitable location.

All results must be continuously updated on a clearly visible public scoreboard.

3. Trial Secretary

The organizing FCI-NCO must appoint a qualified Trial Secretary. The responsibilities include in particular:

- Technical management of the competition
- Provision, allocation and preparation of sufficiently large Indication Areas
- Provision of an adequate number of article layers, stewards, office staff, etc.
- Organization within the Indication Area, including support of participants prior to their start
- Preparation of score sheets for the judges
- Reliable and prompt compilation of results to determine the winner and final rankings

4. Trial Venue and Procedure

The International FCI Article Search Competition shall be conducted according to FCI-StöPr 1–3, with all participants competing on two consecutive days (analogous to FCI-IBGH Special).

Participants must be informed about the nature and condition of the terrain. A training field equivalent to the actual Indication Area must be provided for Article Search training.

Prior to the start of the competition, a veterinary inspection must take place. Dogs appearing sick or suspected of contagious disease shall not be admitted. Females in season are permitted provided they are kept separate from other participants. The veterinary inspection must be completed before the draw. A judge nominated by the FCI Utility Dogs Commission shall be present for the temperament test.

The possession and/or use of electronic devices (e-collars) in the vicinity of the competition, as well as manipulation of the dog (doping), shall result in disqualification, irrespective of national legislation.

Sick or injured dogs may not participate. Furthermore, dogs must not be subjected to prohibited measures intended to improperly alter their appearance, performance, behavior, or character, or to conceal signs of injury or illness.

Each participant must present, during the veterinary inspection, a veterinary certificate in English confirming that the dog is physically capable of fulfilling the competition requirements. Detailed regulations regarding prohibited treatments and measures must be communicated by the organizer's National Organization (LAO) at least six months prior to the competition and published on its website. The notification must include a list of prohibited substances. It is the responsibility of the person in charge of the dog to clarify how any treatment (e.g., waiting periods after veterinary treatment) or other measures may affect the dog's eligibility. The handler must also comply with the regulations of his or her own LAO. A doping test may be conducted. If the LAO or Trial Management decides to take a sample, the person responsible for the dog is obliged to present the dog for examination and any further procedures resulting from the test.

Before the start of the competition, a representative of the FCI Utility Dogs Commission shall convene a team leaders' meeting. Judges, Head of Organization, Trial Secretary

and team leaders must attend. At this meeting, the order in which countries participate in the draw shall be determined by lot. The host country shall draw last.

The public draw for starting order shall take place on the evening before the competition. The catalogue number corresponding to the drawn starting number must be visibly displayed. Participants of the organizing NCO shall draw their starting numbers last.

Within four weeks after the competition, team leaders may submit written feedback and suggestions to the President of the FCI Utility Dogs Commission.

At the award ceremony, the individual and team results shall be announced. The national anthem shall be played for the individual winner and the winning team. All participants and teams achieving a passing result shall be called by name.

5. Trail Judges

The officiating performance judges are responsible for ensuring compliance with all regulations and these specifications.

The organizing FCI-NCO shall propose IGP judges to the FCI Utility Dogs Commission. For FCI-StöPr 3, only one judge may originate from the organizing FCI-NCO.

If judges speak only one language, the organizing FCI-NCO must provide an interpreter knowledgeable in trial procedures and cynology, bound to full confidentiality.

Judges' decisions are final and not subject to appeal.

Judges shall be remunerated by the organizing FCI-NCO in accordance with FCI resolutions. The FCI-determined rates for mileage and daily allowances shall apply. The most economical means of transport must be chosen in agreement with the organizer.

6. Eligibility and Entry of Participants

The total number of participants is limited to 50 per level.

Participants must be members of an FCI-affiliated NCO or an organization invited by the Utility Dogs Commission.

Eligibility to represent an NCO may be based on:

- Citizenship
- Legal residence (according to FCI Statutes)
- The dog owner must either hold the citizenship of the represented country or have had legal residence there for at least 12 months. In the case of dual citizenship, one country may be freely chosen.

- Regardless of nationality, a handler may represent only one country and handle only one dog.
- Dogs not registered in a national studbook or appendix register may also participate. Entries must be submitted by the national organization or an authorized person.

A maximum of three handlers per country shall be admitted in the levels FCI-StöPr 1 and FCI-StöPr 2, and five handlers per country in the level FCI-StöPr 3. Each handler may compete with only one dog. If the maximum number of 50 participants per level is not reached, the President of the Utility Dogs Commission, in consultation with the organizer, may permit the registered and present reserve handlers to compete with their duly registered dogs. If the number of registered reserve handlers exceeds the number of vacant places (up to the maximum of 50 participants), the selection of the teams whose reserve handlers shall complete the number of participants shall be determined by lot at the team leaders' meeting prior to the draw for the order of countries. The decision to complete the number of participants with registered reserve handlers must be communicated to the team leaders eight days after the closing date for entries.

The winner of FCI-StöPr 3 automatically qualifies the following year with the same dog as defending champion, outside the national quota, provided the country submits the entry.

Each FCI National Canine Organization (NCO) may register one reserve participant for the "International FCI Article Search (FCI-StöPr) Competition." This reserve participant shall also be listed in the catalogue. If any registered participant is unable to compete due to illness, accident, or failure to appear, only the registered reserve participants, with their registered dogs, are permitted to take their place.

Members of the Organizing Committee are not allowed to participate as handlers in the International FCI Article Search Competition.

Only dogs selected by the respective NCO may be admitted to the competition.

NCOs must inform the Competition Organizer of the number of their participants by 31 December of the preceding year.

Final named entries must be submitted collectively by the NCO to the Competition Organizer by the deadline indicated in the invitation. The entries must include the following information:

- Name of the NCO
- Name, address, telephone, and e-mail of the team leader
- Name, address, telephone, and e-mail of each participant (including reserves)
- Dog's name, breed (if applicable), date of birth, registration number (if available), identification (chip, tattoo, etc.), and training title

Entries must be submitted by the NCO or by an authorized representative.

Any entries that cannot be accepted must be immediately communicated in writing to the respective NCO.

7. Scorebook

Participants must present a scorebook issued by their NCO. All scorebooks must be submitted collectively before the start of the competition. If no physical scorebook is issued, an electronic performance record may be presented.

Each scorebook must clearly indicate the designation “International FCI Article Search Competition” alongside the results.

8. Ranking and Titles

The participant achieving the highest total score with a passing result shall be declared the winner and awarded the title: “20XX (date) International FCI Article Search Winner.” In the event of equal total scores, the higher individual result shall decide. If still equal, participants shall be ranked ex aequo.

The organizing FCI-NCO must submit the final ranking list with names and nationalities to the FCI.

Team ranking shall be calculated by counting, per country, the highest positive total result of one participant per level. The team with the highest total score shall be declared the winner.

In case of a tie, the better individual result in FCI-StöPr 3 shall decide. If still tied, teams shall be ranked equally.

9. Insurance

The organizer must ensure adequate insurance coverage for staff, judges, and helpers.

Each participant is liable for damages caused by their dog and must provide proof of valid liability insurance upon entry.

Local veterinary regulations must be observed.

10. General Provisions

The provisions of the FCI International Utility Dogs Trial Regulations (IGP), and in particular the FCI-StöPr regulations, are authoritative and must be strictly observed.

In cases of doubt or matters not regulated herein, final decisions shall be made by the President of the FCI Utility Dogs Commission in consultation with the respective judge.

Members of the FCI Utility Dogs Commission shall have free access to all event venues.

The German version is the original text. For reasons of readability, gender-neutral wording has not been consistently applied.